

Escalation & Senior Review Policy

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1. Purpose

This policy governs the escalation of customer complaints and service issues to senior management, ensuring timely and appropriate resolution for complex or sensitive cases.

2. When to Escalate

Escalation is required when: the customer is unsatisfied after two resolution attempts, the issue involves potential legal or regulatory implications, the complaint involves a senior member of staff, the financial value exceeds £500, or the customer explicitly requests escalation.

3. Escalation Tiers

Tier 1: Customer Service Representative (standard cases). Tier 2: Senior Customer Service Manager (complex or repeated complaints). Tier 3: Head of Customer Experience (unresolved Tier 2 cases, legal threats). Tier 4: Director level (regulatory complaints, media involvement).

4. Response Timeframes

Tier 2 escalation: acknowledgement within 4 hours, resolution within 5 business days. Tier 3 escalation: acknowledgement within 2 hours, resolution within 3 business days. Tier 4 escalation: immediate acknowledgement, resolution timeline agreed with customer.

5. Customer Communication During Escalation

The customer must be notified when their case is escalated. They will be given the name and direct contact of their assigned manager. Progress updates must be provided at least every 2 business days.

6. Compensation at Escalation

Escalated cases are eligible for goodwill compensation by the Senior Manager. Compensation may include refunds, account credits, complimentary products, or a formal written apology signed by a senior representative.

7. Final Response Letter

All escalated cases receive a Final Response Letter within 8 weeks. This letter outlines the investigation findings, the decision, and any remedy offered. It also informs the customer of their right to contact the relevant ombudsman if they remain dissatisfied.